

Umax Draco MP3 Player

Meet Count Draco!

The Umax Draco combines an MP3/WMA player, a portable USB storage device, and a voice-recorder into one. Build quality could be an issue if you drop it accidentally.

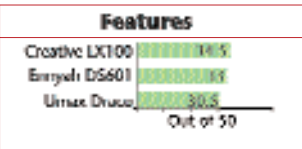
The PC recognises it as a removable drive under Windows 2000, Me and XP. The jog switch lets you switch modes between music, recorder and voice playback, apart from customising other settings.

Bass and treble output for the English tracks were quite weak. However, the Hindi tracks sounded reasonably good. The audio output was low even at maximum volume and not up to the mark.

You can create folders in the removable drive, but only music files stored in the root can be played. The unit gave us just about four hours of continuous playback, while the rated time by the vendor

is 12 hours. The battery gets charged automatically once you connect it to the USB port. However, it tends to heat up while charging.

With its sub-Rs 5000 price tag, the Draco may appeal to the younger crowd. However, the average audio quality, average build-quality, and poor battery life need to be considered before purchasing the product.



SPECIFICATIONS

128 MB flash memory; supports MP3 and WMA formats; multiple repeat function: Loop one, Loop all, A-B/A-V repeat, USB storage, 1.5V AAA chargeable battery

Umax Draco MP3 Player A	
Performance	██████████
Features	██████████
Ease of use	██████████
Value for money	██████████

Price: Rs 4,900
Contact: Neoteric
Phone: 022-24172600
Fax: 022-24185294
E-mail: sales@neoteric-info.com

Altec Lansing MX 5021

Luxurious sound

The first thing that strikes you about these speakers is their design—classy and sleek. The Altec Lansing MX5021 is a 2.1 system with a wireless remote and THX certification.

The *Minority Report* DVD sounded great, but the surround experience was missing. The satellites brought out the tiniest

detail, while the sub punched in the lows with equal strength. Listening to 'O rey chhori' from *Lagaan* made us want to watch the movie again. Gaming benchmarks also gave it a top-notch rating, especially the *Quake III* intro movie.



The MP3 tests also went well. The frequency tests were a bit of a let-

down, especially the mid-range frequencies, but only experienced ears can catch the difference. Distortion was noticed only when we played with the EAX equalizer settings—setting it to rock, pop, etc.

It's steeply priced at Rs 12,000. You can get a 5.1 set for just as much. This is for those who want the best 2.1 sound available.

Price: Rs 12,000
Contact: Zeta Technologies
Phone: 022-24102277
E-mail: tejas@zetaindia.com
Web site: www.alteclansing.com

SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

90 Watts RMS, frequency response 30 Hz ~ 22 KHz, Signal-to-Noise ratio at 1 KHz >80 dB, system Total Harmonic Distortion < 0.3 per cent at -10 dB, satellite drivers—1-inch horn loaded tweeter and two 3-inch mid-range, subwoofer driver—one 6.5-inch Long Throw woofer

Altec Lansing MX 5021 **B+**

Performance	██████████
Features	██████████
Build Quality	██████████
Value for money	██████████

Siemens C60 mobile phone

Flash it!

The Siemens C60 looks good in its grey silver outfit with a dash of chrome that adds beauty. The colour panels are exchangeable, and you can opt for other colour schemes. It has small cramped buttons that are hard to press and lack tactile feedback. The build quality leaves a lot to be desired.

The 7-line colour display screen is nothing to write home about—so long as you use this phone indoors, you won't go blind trying to read the screen. The icon based menu structure is really simple to operate.

You can store 350 phone book entries in all. Support for MMS and Java applications is included. The phone comes with an external camera and flash attachment.

Price: Rs 8,000
Contact: Siemens
Phone: 022 - 2498 7430/46
Fax: 022 - 2496 8085
E-mail: contactus@bom4.siemens.co.in
Web site: www.my-siemens.com

Taking pictures drains the battery very fast—especially when you use the flash.

No infra-red connectivity is provided. The package includes the handset, a 700mAh lithium-ion battery, battery charger and a user guide. The voice clarity is good and the reception is clear. The battery lasts for about three days on normal usage. At just Rs 8,000, the C60 is sensibly priced. We recommend it only if you spend most of your time indoors and are not an SMS junky.

SPECIFICATIONS

Tri-band, 12 bit colour display, 16 polyphonic ringtones, GPRS, 350 phone entries and external camera with flash

Siemens C60 Mobile phone **B+**

Performance	██████████
Features	██████████
Build quality	██████████
Value for money	██████████